



Gender Cell

End-Term Report (2024-25)

Introduction

The Gender Cell of IIT Kanpur is an Institutional body that aims to create a safe, inclusive, and gender-sensitive environment for all members of the campus community. Our mission is to promote awareness about gender equity, prevent incidents of sexual harassment and discrimination, and assist those who may have been impacted by such issues.

This End-Term report summarizes the functioning and activities of the Gender Cell over the past tenure. It outlines the efforts undertaken to raise awareness, the initiatives conducted, the structure of our internal meetings, and the future roadmap as envisioned by the current team.

1) Student Nominees (2024-25)

- Saumya Suyal (PG-F)
- Musale Krushna Pavan (PG-M)
- S Tania (UG-F)
- Yash Giri (UG-M)

2) Word from Student Nominees

The Gender Cell nominees tried their best to increase the visibility and approachability of the cell throughout the year through various events and

awareness drives. We received constant support from faculty members and, in particular, from our dedicated staff member Mrs. Anjani Dubey Ma'am.

Throughout our tenure, the Gender Cell addressed numerous cases involving sexual harassment, gender discrimination, and inequality, offering all possible forms of support to individuals who approached us.

The idea of including the secretary post in the cell was very impactful, and several initiatives were possible only because of teamwork with the secretaries.

A significant observation during our work has been the lack of participation in sensitization sessions and events by a section of the campus community. This gap hinders awareness of both the cell's role and the preventive measures against sexual harassment

3) Events and Initiatives (Month Wise)

2024:

June:

- Carried out Secretary Recruitment drive and build a team of **21** Secys
- Conducted Pride Month Survey for the campus to know gender diversity demographics and public opinion.
- Initiated the Creation of the New Gender Cell Website.

July:

- Published Data for Pride Month Survey on Instagram and other pages
- Created New Gender Cell website: iitk.ac.in/gc covering all the required info and event details for the public.
- Conducted Gender Cell Orientation for Student Guides 2024-25
- Updated Advisory Gender Cell Flexi posters across the campus with contact details of the new nominees
- Conducted Gender Cell Orientation for the Freshers 2024 Batch, explaining the roles and responsibilities of the Cell and various modes of sexual harassment on campus.

August:

- **27th Aug 2024 - Training Session for GC and ICC members:**
The Gender Cell along with the Legal Cell organized a training session cum workshop for the members of GC and ICC led by reputed Lawyer and industry advisor Mr. Alok Bhasin on the topic “Laws Related to Sexual harassment at Work”
- **27th Aug 2024, L18-19 Foyer:** An Open Mic in solidarity with the RG Kar Hospital Case was conducted in collaboration with the Institute Counselling Service. People expressed their stories and views on the importance of safe space and safety for all gender in the society.
- The Gender Cell started the campaign of **#Zero_Sexual_Harassment** across the campus where the Cell pledged to eradicate Sexual harassment in all possible forms and work towards reducing the cases to zero.

September:

- **30th Sep 2025 - Bridging Gaps-** The Student Nominees and Secretaries of Gender Cell conducted Hall level sensitization session for all the First year UG and PG students explaining them about various forms of sexual harassment and gender discrimination and the role of Gender Cell.

October:

- **15th Oct 2025 - ‘Laapata Ladies’ Movie Screening-** The Gender Cell conducted a special screening of ‘Laapata Ladies’ movie which questioned the gender stereotypes in Indian rural regions and sparked important conversations around gender inequality against females. The show was housefull with snacks being provided.
- **4th-6th Oct 2025 - Dedicated Task Force for Udghosh’24-** The Gender Cell nominees and the members of Security Team of Udghosh’24 constituted a dedicated team to handle cases of sexual harassment that

could arise during the fest. Advisory posters were put up at all the participant residences and other common locations.

- **17th-20th Oct 2025 - Dedicated Task Force for Antaragni'24-** The Gender Cell nominees and the members of Antaragni'24 Core team constituted a dedicated team to handle cases of sexual harassment that could arise during the fest. Advisory posters were put up at all the participant residences and other common locations. The team handled 3 cases of Sexual harassment during the fest.

December:

- **4th December 2024 - Releasing First-ever ICC Correspondence Document** - The Gender Cell, in collaboration with the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) released the first-ever ICC Correspondence Document, where the nature of cases of Sexual harassment reported to ICC were mentioned in anonymized format along with the corresponding recommendation and punishment by the ICC.

2025

January:

- **21st Jan: Special Interview with Vox Populi:** Vox interviewed the student nominees of the Gender Cell regarding the present status of sexual harassment on campus, the line of work difference between ICC and GC and on some of the pending work which were discussed in the last interview of Chairperson, Gender Cell with Vox in 2023.
- **29th January 2025 - 'Barbie' Movie Screening-** The Gender Cell conducted a special screening of the 'Barbie' movie in LH-17 which was attended by around 80 people. The movie satirically flips gender roles to question societal norms and highlight gender inequality. Snacks were also

being provided.

February:

- **2nd February 2025 - Bystander Intervention Workshop** - The Gender Cell IIT Kanpur in collaboration with Kamakshi and HeForShe ([@kamakshi.heforshe.kiit](https://www.instagram.com/kamakshi.heforshe.kiit)) from KIIT conducted an online **ByStander Intervention Workshop** by the Invited speakers Adv. Divya R (from the Legal Swan) and Prof. Partibha Chakraborty from KIIT. The workshop empowered individuals to recognize, safely intervene in, and prevent instances of sexual harassment and misconduct.

March:

- **8th March 2025 - Special Women's Day Talk by Adv. Seema Kushwaha** - On the occasion of International Women's Day 2025, the Gender Cell invited esteemed Supreme Court Advocate Ms. Seema Kushwaha who was the legal counsel for Nirbhaya in the 2012 Delhi Case and the founder of Samridhi Bharat Trust, to deliver a talk on '*Women's Safety and Empowerment: Role of Judiciary ?*' Prof. Pratik Sen (DoSA) was the special guest for the event. The talk was housefull.
- **9th-11th March 2025 - Online Meme Competition** - The Gender Cell organized an Online meme making competition on the occasion of International Women's Day 2025 where the challenge was to make memes on the theme: "*Breaking Gender Stereotypes & Raising Awareness Against Sexual Harassment*". The Top 3 winners were awarded amazon coupons.
- **22nd March 2025 - 5KM Run and Walk** - The Gender Cell organized the 7th edition of the 5KM Run and Walk with the theme "Silence Does not Mean Consent: Stop Sexual Harassment". The event was a massive success with more than **650** participants and **70+** volunteers from all age groups and sections of IIT Kanpur. The top 10 winners in the 8 categories were awarded Certificates and T-shirts. The Chief guests for the event

were Prof. Devlina Chatterjee (PO, ICC) and Prof. Pratik Sen (DoSA)
EVENT BUDGET: [HERE](#)

4) Social Media Outreach

- The Gender Cell team of 2025-26 focused greatly on the social media outreach, increasing the number of Instagram followers from around 200 to over **570+** by enhancing engagement, posting reels and advisories along with regular event updates.
- The Gender Cell team posted a “Meet the Team” Instagram post where the student team of Nominees and Secretaries were introduced to the campus community.
- **Women’s Equality Day** (Aug 26 2024) was celebrated by a captivating post challenging the stereotypes faced by women, through movie characters namely Jaya from Laapata Ladies, Shashi from English Vinglish etc. and how they had overcome societal issues.
- A unique type of post with the prompt “I need sexual harassment to Stop because....” was released in two parts which gathered huge positive response from the campus community.
- Celebrated **New Year 2025** through Instagram Post, with a commitment to build a community rooted in equality, respect, and a shared desire of achieving *#Zero_Sexual_Harassment*
- Collaborated with Kamakshi & HeForShe from KIIT to create reels and posts for **Republic Day 2025** with the prompt “On this Republic Day, I pledge to” gathering significant attention from both IITK and KIIT.
- Updated Advisory Guidelines for **Techkriti 2025** explaining some Do's and Don'ts to help ensure the festival stays safe, respectful, and enjoyable for everyone. However, despite of multiple reminders and requests, there was no response from the Techkriti team to repost the same from their Instagram handle.

5) Meeting Minutes

1st Meeting: 29 July 2024 (FB212)

1. **Website Updates & Compliance:** The student members presented the Gender Cell website draft. Key updates include uploading official mandates, addressing copyright concerns, adding legal resources (like the POSH Act and Indian Penal Code), and improving user engagement with a visually appealing layout.
2. **Awareness Initiatives:** The committee proposed a **campus-wide quiz** on sexual harassment awareness (possibly during orientation), hall-level sessions for gender sensitization, and collaborations with the Counseling Service and Media Council.
3. **Preventive Measures During Fests:** To counter increased harassment during festivals, **mandatory sessions for fest coordinators**, informative posters, brochures with Gender Cell info, and campus-wide billboards (inspired by IIT Delhi) were recommended.

2nd Meeting: Joint Meeting with ICC - 4th November 2024

1. **Awareness Video Initiative:** A video on gender sensitization, covering sexual harassment, legal consequences, and the POSH Act, will be developed using either presenters or animation. It will be separate for both faculties and students. The Media Cell will produce the video after script preparation, and the Director may be requested to mandate its viewing.
2. **Visual Campaign & FAQ Section:** Plans were made to design minimal-text, visually rich posters (based on eLearnPOSH templates) and create a comprehensive FAQ section on the website to clarify gender-related policies and consequences.
3. **Action Items & Documentation:** Students (Yash and Shruti) were tasked with updating the correspondence document on offenses and punishments. Other tasks include preparing video content, creating a

common mailing list, and acquiring a Canva Pro subscription for design work.

3rd Meeting: 11th March 2025:

The Gender Cell members conducted an online meeting to address urgent privacy concerns of women at Dhobi Ghat. Since the installation of CCTV cameras in places of open defecation raised issues of privacy for the people staying at the Dhobi Ghat, Gender Cell members proactively took cognizance of the issue and decided to meet the Director Prof. Manindra Agarwal to discuss the same. The Gender Cell student members received a written petition signed by 200+ student members addressing the same issue.

Meeting With Director Sir: On Meeting Prof. Manindra Agarwal, the urgent request of removing the camera from the places of open defecation at the Dhobi Ghat was accepted and the cameras were removed the next day.

However, they were suddenly reinstalled 2-3 days later with changed positions but yet covering the same area.

6) On-Going Work (to be carried forward by incoming nominees)

- **Completion of Advisory Video:** There has been a significant progress in creating the advisory video for the students with the script and mock video being ready. However, the script for faculties need more reviewing from other faculty members and Director, IITK. This needs to be coordinated with the IMOC later for quick shooting of the video.

7) Recommendations for Next Tenure

- There can be increased efforts towards publicising events by installing multiple Flexi posters across campus for all the Gender Cell events.

- Anti-Drug measures need to be strengthened across the campus as they have been openly spreading and leading to sexual harassment cases.
- A Gender Cell App with all the relevant data and method for reaching out to the Student Nominees of the Gender Cell and ICC can be created.
- Website Updation with official servers need to be taken up.
- There should be a Gender Cell Mid-Term Report (around October-November) highlighting the events and efforts.
- Billboards with Anti-Sexual harassment advisory can be put across the campus (like IIT-Delhi)
- Sensitization of the Gender Cell Secretary should be mandatory after the recruitment.
- Social Media outreach in association with IMOC can be explored.
- Cyber Sexual harassment cases are often difficult to deal with. A permanent Cyber Security Cell needs to be established at DDIA
- Gender Cell and ICC members shall often meet and jointly discuss the updates on the situation on the campus pertaining to sexual harassment.

8) Final Note

It was truly an enriching experience and an honour for all the nominees to serve the campus as Gender Cell nominees, sensitize the campus community, and help the students impacted by gender discrimination and sexual harassment. We tried our best to make Gender Cell available, visible, approachable, and accessible for each and every member of the campus and beyond.